Compliance code

Workplace facilities and the working environment

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Contents

Preface . . . 2
Part 1 – Introduction . . . 3
Purpose . . . 3
Scope . . . 3
Application . . . 3
Who has duties? . . . 3
Consultation . . . 5
The risk management process . . . 7
What are workplace facilities and the working environment? . . . 7
Why do employees need facilities? . . . 7
Identifying what facilities employers need to provide . . . 8
Maintaining and cleaning facilities and the working environment . . . 9
Monitoring . . . 9
Part 2 – Facilities . . . 10
Toilets . . . 10
Number and gender ratios . . . 10
Design . . . 12
Access . . . 12
Facilities for toilets . . . 12
Hand washing . . . 13
Drinking water . . . 14
Design . . . 14
Dining facilities . . . 14
Access . . . 14
Design . . . 15
Tables . . . 15
Seating . . . 15
Food handling and hygiene . . . 16
Water . . . 16
Personal storage . . . 18
Changing rooms . . . 18
Design . . . 18
Fittings . . . 19
Storage . . . 19
Shower facilities . . . 20
Design . . . 21
Facilities for showers . . . 21
Part 3 – Facilities for special workplaces . . . 22
Outdoor work . . . 22
Mobile, temporary, and remote work . . . 23

Communications for mobile, isolated and remote employees . . . 24
Employer-provided accommodation . . . 24
Part 4 – The work environment . . . 26
Entry and exit . . . 26
Emergency exits and access . . . 26
Housekeeping . . . 27
Workspace . . . 27
Minimising noise in the work area . . . 28
Heat and cold . . . 28
Hot environments . . . 29
Cold environments . . . 30
Thermal comfort . . . 30
Ventilation, air quality and air conditioning . . . 31
Lighting . . . 32
Recommended maintained illuminances for various types of tasks, activities or interiors (from AS/NZS 1680.1 Interior and workplace lighting) . . . 33
Seating . . . 34
Flooring . . . 35
Part 5 – Responding to emergencies . . . 36
Emergency planning . . . 36
Emergency management plans . . . 36
First Aid . . . 37
List of appendices . . . 38
Appendix A – The compliance framework . . . 39
Appendix B – The relationship between facilities and employee health, safety and welfare . . . 40
Appendix C – Documents associated with this compliance code . . . 41
Regulations . . . 41
WorkSafe publications (available at worksafe.vic.gov.au) . . . 41
Australian standards . . . 41
Other relevant publications . . . 41
Appendix D – Number of toilets and washbasins needed for employees in a workplace . . . 42
Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist . . . 44
Appendix F – Heat and cold risk controls . . . 56

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Preface

This Compliance Code (**Code**) provides practical guidance for those who have duties or obligations to provide facilities at workplaces and to maintain workplace conditions under the *Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004* (**OHS Act**) and *Occupational Health and Safety Regulations 2017* (**OHS Regulations**).

The Code was developed by WorkSafe Victoria (**WorkSafe**). Representatives of employers and employees were consulted during its preparation. It was made under the OHS Act and approved by The Hon Danny Pearson MP, Minister for WorkSafe and the TAC.

Duty holders under the OHS Act and OHS Regulations should use this Code to assist them in complying with their duties under the OHS legislation. This Code replaces the Compliance Code – *Workplace amenities and work environment* (2008), which is no longer in force and effect.

While the guidance provided in the Code is not mandatory, a duty holder who complies with the Code will – to the extent it deals with their duties or obligations under the OHS Act and OHS Regulations – be taken to have complied with those duties or obligations.

If conditions at the workplace or the way work is done raise different or additional risks not covered by the Code, compliance must be achieved by other means. WorkSafe publishes guidance to assist with this at **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

Failure to observe the Code may be used as evidence in proceedings for an offence under the OHS Act or OHS Regulations. However, a duty holder will not fail to meet their legal duty simply because they have not followed the Code. A WorkSafe inspector may cite the Code in a direction or condition in an improvement notice or prohibition notice as a means of achieving compliance.

A health and safety representative (**HSR**) may cite the Code in a provisional improvement notice when providing directions on how to remedy an alleged contravention of the OHS Act or OHS Regulations.

Approval for the Code may be varied or revoked by the Minister. To confirm the Code is current and in force, go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

Part 1 – Introduction

Purpose

1. The purpose of this Code is to provide practical guidance to duty holders about how to comply with their duties under the OHS Act to provide adequate facilities for the welfare of employees and a working environment that is safe and without risks to health.

Scope

2. This Code applies to the provision of workplace facilities for the welfare of employees and the health and safety of the working environment in all workplaces. WorkSafe's Facilities in construction compliance code applies to certain construction workplaces and employers and persons who manage or control those workplaces will need to refer to that code.

Application

3. This Code applies to all employers, people who manage or control a workplace, independent contractors, and employees including HSRs.

4. People who employ employees under a contract of employment or under a contract of training, like apprentices, are employers for the purposes of the OHS Act and OHS Regulations.

Who has duties?

Note

The word **must** indicates a legal requirement that has to be complied with. The words **need(s) to** are used to indicate a recommended course of action in accordance with duties and obligations under Victoria's health and safety legislation. The word **should** is used to indicate a recommended optional course of action.

5. Employers must, so far as is reasonably practicable, provide and maintain a working environment that is safe and without health risks to their employees. OHS Act s21

6. To ensure that employers provide a working environment that is safe and without risks to health, they must eliminate risks to health and safety so far as is reasonably practicable. If it is not reasonably practicable to eliminate the risks to health and safety, employers must reduce those risks so far as is reasonably practicable. OHS Act s20

Part 1 – Introduction

7. Regard must be had to the following matters in determining what is (or was at a particular time) reasonably practicable in relation to ensuring health and safety:
   - the likelihood of the hazard or risk concerned eventuating
   - the degree of harm that would result if the hazard or risk eventuated
   - what the person concerned knows, or ought reasonably to know, about the hazard or risk and any ways of eliminating or reducing the hazard or risk
   - the availability and suitability of ways to eliminate or reduce the hazard or risk
   - the cost of eliminating or reducing the hazard or risk. OHS Act s20

Note

For information about what the term *'reasonably practicable'* means when complying with Part 3 of the OHS Act or the OHS Regulations, see the WorkSafe Position – *How WorkSafe applies the law in relation to reasonably practicable* at **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

8. Employers must provide, so far as is reasonably practicable, adequate facilities for the welfare of employees at any workplace under the management and control of the employer OHS Act s21(2)(d) The term 'employees' includes independent contractors that the employer engages and employees of the independent contractors, for matters over which the employer has control, or would have control if not for any agreement claiming to limit or remove that control.

9. Employers must ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, that persons other than employees are not exposed to risks to their health or safety arising from the conduct undertaken by the employer. OHS Act s23

10. Employees, while at work, must take reasonable care for their own health and safety and that of others who could be affected by their acts or omissions in the workplace. Employees must also cooperate with their employer's actions taken to comply with OHS Act or OHS Regulations requirements. OHS Act s25(1)

11. Employers must, so far as is reasonably practicable, monitor conditions at any workplace under the employer's management and control. OHS Act s22(1)(b)

12. A person with the management or control of a workplace must ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, that the workplace and the ways of entering and leaving it are safe and without health risks. These duties only apply to matters over which the person has management or control. OHS Act s26(1), (2)

13. If an employer identifies inadequate facilities in a workplace and they do not have enough management or control of the workplace to fix the issue, they need to attempt to influence the person who does manage or control that workplace to fix the issue for the welfare of their employees. The adequacy of facilities should also be taken into account when employers are considering whether to enter into a lease and, if they are inadequate, make all attempts to address the issues, or consider alternative premises.

Who has management or control of a workplace?

Management or control of a workplace depends on factors like ownership and who can make changes to the workplace.

An employer who occupies and owns a property will typically have management or control of the building, associated plant that forms part of the building or structure and any plant that they own and use at the workplace.

Whether **an employer who leases a building** can undertake structural changes, for example installing lighting into a ceiling, will depend on the terms of the lease agreement. Therefore, the extent to which an employer has management or control may vary from workplace to workplace. However, employers must still ensure that they meet their duties under the OHS Act, as detailed above.

14. If employers design or modify their workplace, they may also have extra duties under the OHS Act in regards to the design. OHS Act s28 WorkSafe recommends that employers read sections of the Code that apply to workplace design.

For information

Employers and designers may also have duties under other legislation regarding facilities, such as under health or building regulations. For example, new buildings and major renovations must comply with the National Construction Code.

Being compliant with those duties does not necessarily mean you are compliant with the OHS Act. You need to be compliant with both.

Consultation

15. Employers must, so far as is reasonably practicable, consult with employees on certain matters related to health or safety that directly affect, or are likely to directly affect, them. OHS Act s35

16. If employees are represented by an HSR, the consultation must involve that HSR (with or without the involvement of the employees directly). OHS Act s35(4) and OHS Regulations r21

17. The duty to consult also extends to independent contractors (including any employees of the independent contractor) engaged by the employer in relation to matters over which the employer has control. OHS Act s35

Note

The characteristics of the workplace will have an impact on the way consultation is undertaken. For example, consider:

- the size and structure of the business
- the nature of the work
- work arrangements (such as shift work or flexible work arrangements)
- working arrangements (such as work location and available technologies)
- characteristics of employees (such as disability, gender, language or literacy)
- any agreed procedures between the employer and employees for undertaking consultation
- the presence and number of HSRs
- the health and safety committee

Go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au** for more information on consultation.

18. The duty to consult with employees and independent contractors includes, for example, when an employer is:
    - identifying or assessing hazards or risks to health or safety at the workplace
    - making decisions about measures to control such risks
    - making decisions about the adequacy of facilities for the welfare of employees of the employer, and
    - proposing changes to the workplace, plant or substances used at the workplace that may affect the health or safety of employees. OHS Act s35
19. It is important to consult with your employees as early as possible when planning to:
    - relocate to new workplaces
    - refurbish, renovate or redesign existing workplaces
    - carry out work in a new environment.
20. Employers who are required to consult with employees must share information about the matter with employees, including independent contractors and any HSRs. Employees must be given a reasonable opportunity to express their views and those views must be taken into account before a decision is made. If the employer and the employees have agreed to procedures for undertaking consultation about health and safety matters, the consultation must be undertaken in accordance with those procedures. OHS Act s35(5)
21. Employees and contractors may have practical suggestions for solving problems.

Note

Regulation 21 of the OHS Regulations details how employers must involve HSRs in consultation where it is required under the OHS Act or OHS Regulations. This includes:

- providing the HSR with all the information about the matter that the employer provides, or intends to provide, to the employees
- providing that information to the HSR a reasonable time before providing the information to the employees, unless it is not reasonably practicable to do so
- inviting the HSR to meet, and meeting to consult on matters
- giving the HSR a reasonable opportunity to express views about the matter
- taking into account the HSRs views about the matter.

Go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au** for more information on consultation with HSRs.

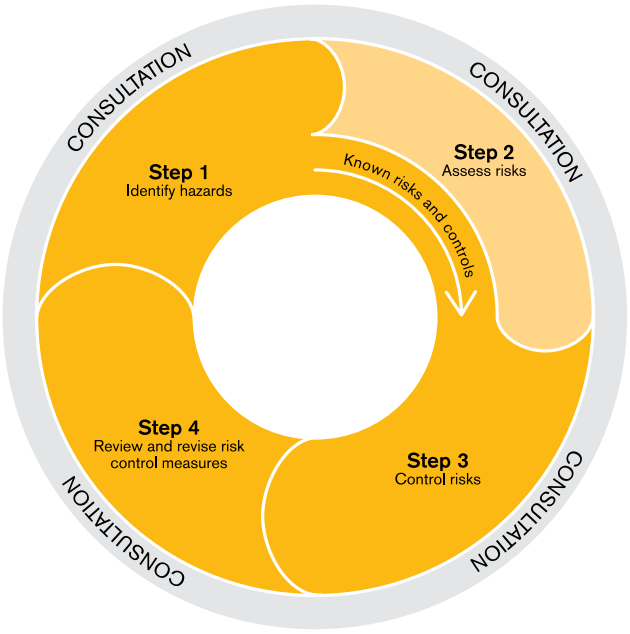
Part 1 – Introduction

The risk management process

22. Using a risk management process (see diagram below) helps employers to comply with their duties under the OHS Act. Having a risk management process will help employers assess the working environment and the adequacy of facilities at the workplace. The risk management process involves the following steps:

- identify hazards
- assess, where needed, any associated risks to health or safety
- control risks to health or safety associated with identified hazards
- monitor, review, and where needed, revise risk controls.

Diagram 1 – The risk management process



What are workplace facilities and the working environment?

23. Workplace facilities include toilets, shelter, seating, dining rooms, change rooms, drinking water, personal storage and washing facilities. Facilities need to be kept clean and hygienic and be cleaned regularly.

24. The working environment includes such things as the workspace, temperature, air quality, lighting and floors.

Why do employees need facilities?

25. Providing adequate and suitable workplace facilities is necessary for employees' health, safety and welfare. The OHS Act defines the term *'health'* to include psychological health. See the table at Appendix B for how facilities are linked to employee health, safety and welfare.

26. As well as being a physical health hazard, not being able to access adequate facilities may also be a psychological or psychosocial hazard, discrimination, or other unlawful workplace situation.

Note

Employers should consider other relevant laws (both state and federal) that may also apply to providing adequate workplace facilities. For example, new buildings and major renovations must comply with the National Construction Code.

Part 1 – Introduction

Identifying what facilities employers need to provide

27. The OHS Act says that employers must provide, so far as is reasonably practicable, facilities for employees' and contractors' welfare at any workplace that they manage and control. However, before they decide if the facilities are suitable, employers must consult with employees, including contractors, and any HSRs. OHS Act s21(2)(d), s35(1)(c)

28. When working out what facilities they need to provide for employees and contractors, employers need to consider:

    • the type and place of work

    • the make-up and size of their workforce

    • employee access

    • cleaning and maintenance.

29. Employers must also consult with affected employees and any HSRs and review whether the facilities are meeting employee needs.

30. More detail on individual facilities is covered in the sections below. Employers can also use the checklist in Appendix E of this Code which provides details of what to consider to help them decide on facilities.

31. The number of employees and contractors at the workplace will impact the size and type of facilities needed.

32. Employers need to ensure that all employees and contractors have suitable privacy and security. For example, when choosing or designing facilities, employers must consult with their employees. They should consider whether employees have additional access or personal needs or have other cultural or gender-related needs. Examples can include:

    • lactation facilities with a private, comfortable space to breastfeed or express breastmilk and a refrigerator or other means for safely storing breastmilk at the right temperature, or

    • prayer or religious rooms.

33. Employers must consider employees' psychological health. The inability to access a safe and secure toilet, shower, changing facility or other required facilities identified in consultation may also constitute a psychosocial hazard.

Maintaining and cleaning facilities and the working environment

34. The requirement to provide and maintain a working environment that is safe and without risks to health means that facilities need to be kept in hygienic, safe, secure and working order. Spills, blockages and waste should be dealt with quickly as part of good housekeeping practices.

35. Workplaces and facilities need to be cleaned regularly. Cleaning may be needed at each shift change or daily, but can be needed more often depending on the type or nature of the work. The cleaning schedule needs to account for the hygienic maintenance of facilities in high-use areas, like dining areas, toilets, urinals, hand washing facilities and showers. More information on cleaning for specific facilities is covered throughout this code.

36. Broken or damaged infrastructure and fittings (such as plumbing, air conditioning and lights) need to be repaired promptly. Equipment and furniture like toasters, fridges, lockers or seating need to be kept in good repair so employees can use them safely.

Managing the risks of infectious disease outbreaks

When an outbreak of an infectious disease is affecting the community, additional hygiene measures may be required to prevent infections in the workplace. For example, making arrangements for employees to wash or sanitise their hands more often than usual, increasing the cleaning routine in line with employee movements (eg between shifts), improving natural or mechanical ventilation, implementing measures such as physical distancing and staggered start/finish times and providing additional temporary facilities.

For more information about managing the risks of infectious diseases, including preparing for a pandemic, go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

Monitoring

37. Employers must monitor conditions of their workplace, which may include facilities, and the health of their employees. OHS Act s22(1)(a) and OHS Act s22(1)(b)

38. A review of facilities needs to be done when:

- an HSR asks for a review
- work practices, equipment or workplaces are changed
- more employees are brought on
- new systems of work are introduced
- new risks emerge (such as infectious disease outbreaks or bushfires)
- a complaint has been lodged about the adequacy of facilities or the work environment
- an incident occurs in relation to the facilities that impacts the health, safety or welfare of employees.

Part 2 – Facilities

39. For fixed workplaces, an employer needs to provide, so far as reasonably practicable, clean drinking water, access to toilets, hand washing facilities and a clean place to eat in the workplace.

40. Further facilities, such as fully accessible showers and change rooms, may need to be provided in some workplaces, where identified that it is required, and where reasonably practicable to do so.

41. Employers need to assess the basic facilities for mobile, temporary or remote workplaces and give employees information about where and how to access those facilities. Extra facilities, like accommodation, may be needed at some workplaces. For information about providing facilities for employees performing mobile, temporary or remote work see Part 3 of this code.

Toilets

42. All employees need to have access to clean and hygienic toilet facilities at all times while at work, so far as is reasonably practicable.

43. Where reasonably practicable, toilets for employees need to be separate from those for other people, like visitors, clients, patients or the public. This is so that employees can safely access and use toilets at any time.

Note

As well as being a physical health hazard, not being able to access suitable toilet facilities may also be a psychological or psychosocial hazard, or discrimination, or other unlawful workplace situation. Employers need to consider other relevant laws (both state and federal) that may also apply to providing adequate workplace facilities.

Number and gender ratios

44. Employers should consider the needs and make-up of the workforce, and must consult with employees when deciding whether the facilities are adequate for the welfare of all employees, so far as is reasonably practicable.

45. This code sets out what WorkSafe considers to be the minimum number of toilets and washbasins needed for employees in a workplace, so far as is reasonably practicable.

46. Accessible toilets need to be provided. An accessible toilet is a toilet which is fully accessible by persons of all genders with a disability, including for wheelchair use, and contains a sanitary disposal unit. The signage for these toilets is usually a wheelchair and signage should include braille. Where relevant, employers also need to comply with accessible toilet requirements (including minimum numbers) in the National Construction Code or Australian Standards such as AS 1428.1 *Design for access and mobility*.

Part 2 – Facilities

47. In workplaces where the total number of people who usually work there is 10 or fewer, one all genders toilet (sometimes called 'unisex') may be provided for employees instead of separate male and female toilets. If only one toilet is provided, this needs to be a fully accessible toilet.

48. In workplaces where the total number of people who usually work there is over 10 people, WorkSafe's view of the minimum numbers of toilets needed is set out in Appendix D in the form of ratios. These ratios are based on the number of employees, the make-up of the workforce and the type of building. These numbers include the provision of at least one all genders toilet in every workplace for every 50 employees, so far as is reasonably practicable. All-genders toilets are in addition to the need to provide an accessible toilet.

49. An all-genders toilet facility is a toilet which does not have gendered signage and can be used by a person of any gender or gender identity. The signage for these toilets should be a silhouette of a toilet with the words *'All genders'* or *'All-genders'* above or below the picture and should include braille. They should be in an ambulant accessible sanitary compartment and contain a sanitary disposal unit, but do not need to contain a urinal.

50. If it is not reasonably practicable to provide the number of all genders toilets set out in Appendix D, employers need to determine what else they can do to minimise the risk to employees that do not have access to an all gender toilet.

51. Some factors that might be relevant when considering whether it is reasonably practicable to provide the numbers of toilets set out in Appendix D are:

- the number of employees in the workplace
- whether there are enough toilets for peak use times (eg during shift breaks)
- feedback from consultation with employees (see Part 1 for more information on consultation)
- whether additional toilets can be built including whether renovations are occurring or are planned, and the cost involved
- if the employer does not own the building, whether they have attempted to influence the person who manages or controls the workplace (usually the landlord) to make changes
- whether some male/female toilet blocks can be repurposed as all genders toilets, while taking into account the numbers of male/female toilets set out in Appendix D.

52. No single matter determines what is reasonably practicable. The test involves weighing up of each matter in the context of the circumstances and facts of the particular case. For further information about reasonable practicability, see Part 1.

53. If employers are considering having only all genders toilets in the workplace, they need to ensure they comply with any other requirements, such as the National Construction Code. They also need to consider whether other OHS risks might arise by having only all genders toilets and consult with employees who are or are likely to be affected (eg some employees may wish to retain female or male toilets).

Part 2 – Facilities

Note

Employers may also have duties under legislation in relation to the number of toilets provided. For example, new buildings and major renovations must comply with the National Construction Code. It specifies the number of toilets that need to be provided for employees in buildings that are used as workplaces.

Design

54. Toilets need to comply with authorised or approved design standards, for example the sanitary compartment requirements under the National Construction Code or Australian Standards (see Appendix C).

55. Where it is not reasonably practicable to provide access to permanent toilets, portable toilets may need to be provided. Portable toilets need to be installed securely to prevent them falling over or being unstable and be fitted with a lockable door, lighting and ventilation. Portable toilets should be provided in the same ratios as permanent toilets, including accessible and all genders toilets.

56. Toilets need to:

- be fitted with a hinged seat and lid
- have adequate lighting and ventilation
- be clearly marked
- be fitted with a hinged door capable of locking from the inside on each cubicle
- be designed to allow emergency access
- be located separately from any other room by a soundproof wall or by a separate entrance
- be separated from any other room by an airlock.

Other types of toilets such as squat toilets

Consultation with employees may identify the need for squat toilets to be provided. Squat toilets may be provided to cater to employees from culturally diverse backgrounds, where it is reasonably practicable to do so. The provision of squat toilets should be made in consultation with any HSRs and employees. The number of employees, composition of the workforce and any accessibility requirements should also be considered when providing squat toilets. Additional clothes hooks and water hoses should be included in each squat toilet cubicle.

Access

57. Toilets need to be accessible, preferably inside a building at the workplace or as close as possible to the workplace, to eliminate or reduce any risk to employee safety while accessing them. In multi-storey buildings, toilets should be located on at least every second storey.

58. The employer needs to consider special arrangements for mobile or temporary workplaces (see Part 3 for more information).

Facilities for toilets

59. Toilets provided by employers need to have:

- enough toilet paper for each toilet and all persons using them
- hand washing facilities
- hygienic hand drying facilities
- rubbish bins.

60. If identified as needed at the workplace, employers should also consider including:

- sharps disposal units
- suitable and hygienic ways to dispose of incontinence products.

Part 2 – Facilities

Hand washing

61. Workplaces need to have hand washing facilities available for employees to maintain personal hygiene and clean the by-products of their work from their hands before eating or leaving the workplace.

62. Employees need to be able to wash their hands at different times (eg after visits to the toilet, performing personal or health care tasks, handling animals or chemicals, or handling dirty or greasy items such as machinery and before and after meal breaks).

63. Hand washing facilities should:

- be near toilets if toilets do not have internal hand washing facilities
- be separate from troughs or sinks used in work processes
- include hot and cold water outlets or temperature mixing outlets
- have soap or other cleaning products
- have hygienic hand drying facilities (for example, paper towels or air hand dryers), and
- have waste bins for disposing of paper towels, etc.

64. Where temperature mixing outlets such as mixer taps are installed they need to allow the user to control the water temperature. The maximum hot water temperature needs to be set at a suitable temperature to avoid scalding.

65. Mirrors should be provided near hand washing facilities.

66. A risk assessment may help to identify how many hand washing basins are needed for some work processes, in addition to those provided with toilets. For example, some work activities can expose people to contaminants or infectious agents that pose a risk to employees and others. These conditions may mean that extra hand washing facilities are needed, above or separate to those provided with toilets.

67. Employers need to provide hand washing basins in the ratios described in Appendix D.

For information

Some workplaces, like kitchens, food production and health care facilities, must also comply with health regulation requirements and guidelines for hand washing. New buildings and major renovations must also comply with the National Construction Code's requirements for hand washing basins. The National Construction Code has requirements for plumbing, including hot water safety regulations. Refer to the relevant Australian Standards and **vba.vic.gov.au** for more information on plumbing laws and water temperature regulations.

Part 2 – Facilities

Drinking water

68. Clean, potable, cool drinking water needs to be provided for employees. Drinking enough fluids is essential for normal body functioning.

69. Drinking water should be:

- free of charge
- supplied so that there is one drinking point for every 40 employees or part thereof
- nearby or within reach of employees who cannot leave their work task.

70. Sometimes, when workplaces are temporary, remote or mobile, employers cannot provide drinking points for employees. This may include employees such as delivery workers, transport drivers, security personnel, park rangers and gardeners, forestry employees, sales representatives, emergency personnel, or mobile community health employees. In these cases, employers need to identify nearby public drinking water facilities for employees or provide those employees with bottled water, or containers for employees to take water with them, at no charge to the employee.

Design

71. Drinking water provided by employers should be:

- from outlets that are separate from toilet or washing facilities, to avoid contamination
- hygienically provided in disposable or washable drinking containers or delivered by a drinking fountain so that employees do not share drinking containers. Where drinking fountains are provided, these and the filters should be regularly tested, cleaned, changed and maintained.

For information

You can find more information on drinking water quality in the Australian Drinking Water Guidelines endorsed by the National Health and Medical Research Council **www.nhmrc.gov.au**.

Dining facilities

72. Employers need to ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, that employees can access hygienic facilities for preparing and eating meals while at work.

73. Dining facilities need to be cleaned regularly, generally at least daily.

Access

74. Access to dining facilities and the types of facilities needed depends on:

- the nature of the work and the workplace
- the number of employees
- the working environment
- the location
- any existing facilities that are available, and
- the times that employees may be working.

75. This means that depending on the circumstances, a range of different types of facilities and access arrangements may be suitable, such as a separate dining room, a shared or public facility like a canteen or cafeteria, or an appropriate allowance of time to access facilities for remotely located or mobile employees. Employers need to consult with employees and any HSRs to ensure that dining facilities are meeting employee needs.

Part 2 – Facilities

Design

76. A separate dining room needs to be provided where:
    - 10 or more employees usually eat at a workplace at one time
    - the nature of the work causes a risk to the health, safety or welfare of employees from preparing food or eating in the workplace (for example, when there are workplace contaminants like lead, silica, asbestos, infectious/biological agents, etc).
77. The dining room needs to:
    - be kept clean and hygienic and be protected from weather
    - be separated from any hazard (including noise, heat and atmospheric contaminants and conditions, and toilet facilities)
    - be separate from any work process or area
    - be kept, so far as is reasonably practicable, within a safe temperature range for safe food handling, hygiene and comfort.
78. Dining areas should have 1m^2 of clear space for each person likely to use the dining room at one time. Clear space means free of any furniture, fittings or obstacles. This means that the smallest size of a dining area for 10 employees would be 10m^2, plus extra space for furniture, fittings such as sinks and benches, and obstacles such as pillars.
79. A separate dining area does not need to be provided where there are nine or fewer employees who usually eat at one time, as long as there is no risk to the health, safety or welfare of employees from preparing food or eating in the workplace.
80. Some employees may have access to dining facilities in a shared or public canteen or cafeteria, although the employees may work for different employers. Employers should ensure that these dining facilities have room for all their employees who may use them and that employees can access the facilities free of charge.

Space requirements during an infectious disease outbreak

During an infectious disease outbreak, additional space and physical distancing requirements may apply to facilities such as dining areas, change rooms and showers to limit transmission in the workplace. Additional requirements during an infectious disease outbreak such as a pandemic will be made by Direction of the Chief Health Officer and the Department of Health. Where reasonably practicable, alternative facilities should be provided.

Tables

81. When a dining table (or tables) needs to be provided (see Examples of providing dining facilities table below), it should allow a minimum of 600mm width by 300mm depth of table space per person.

Seating

82. Chairs or seats with back support need to be provided for each person likely to be eating at one time.

Part 2 – Facilities

Food handling and hygiene

83. Employers need to ensure that dining facilities have the things that employees need to prepare and eat food and are clean and hygienic.

84. Facilities need to be provided for washing utensils. This should be a sink and draining board with hot and cold water, but buckets or tubs may be provided for washing when fixed facilities are not possible. Any buckets or tubs used need to be clean and kept only for dishwashing use. Washing utensils and detergent also need to be provided.

85. Food warming facilities, such as a microwave oven, need to be provided.

86. Vermin and dust-proof storage needs to be provided for all food and utensils. This needs to include a refrigerator or cooler big enough to store perishable foods for all employees using the facilities.

87. Rubbish bins or containers need to be provided for the dining facility and be emptied as needed and at least daily. Bins or containers need to be insect and vermin-proof.

Water

88. Clean drinking water needs to be provided for dining rooms and dining areas. The water supply needs to be separate from any basin used for washing hands. An appliance that provides boiling water as required is desirable, but an electric kettle may be suitable in workplaces with a small number of staff. At workplaces that are not in a fixed room or building, water may be boiled on site or brought there.

89. There needs to be enough water to supply all employees eating at one time. The water must be of drinking quality.

Part 2 – Facilities

Examples of providing dining facilities	
For large permanent workplaces (10 or more employees who usually eat at the workplace at one time)	A separate dining room needs to be provided. The dining room needs to be hygienic, separated from the work area, separated from all hazards, protected from weather and allow 1m^2 of clear space (plus extra for furnishings, fittings and obstacles) per employee using it at any one time. It needs to provide enough seats and tables (of a suitable size) and suitable crockery and cutlery. A sink, microwave, refrigerator, hot and cold running water, facilities for boiling water and clean storage for utensils and food need to be offered. Washing utensils and detergent, facilities for boiling water and rubbish bins need to be provided. The room and appliances need to be cleaned regularly and rubbish removed at least daily.
For smaller permanent workplaces (nine or fewer employees) where the work poses no risk from preparing food or eating in the workplace	A separate dining area needs to be provided. It needs to be hygienic, protected from the weather and hazards, and free of tools and work materials. If a facility such as a shared or public canteen or cafeteria is accessible to employees in a building near the workplace, employers need to ensure that it is available to all employees free of charge. The workplace needs to have a sink with running water and a clean storage cupboard. Some crockery and cutlery needs to be provided, as well as washing utensils and detergent, facilities for boiling water and rubbish bins. The eating area and appliances need to be cleaned regularly and rubbish removed at least daily. Where possible, a refrigerator or cooler should be provided.
Workplaces where work processes pose a risk to the health, safety and welfare of employees	In workplaces where the nature of the work causes a risk to the health, safety or welfare of employees from preparing food or eating in the workplace, a separate dining room needs to be provided, no matter how few employees.
For mobile, temporary or remote workplaces	Where the work involves travelling between different workplaces or is remote or seasonal, access to dining facilities may involve organising rosters for mobile employees (such as bus drivers or couriers) to ensure that they are back at their base location for meal breaks. Otherwise, mobile employees like sales representatives may need to use a shared or public canteen or cafeteria. Some temporary workplaces may consider providing portable dining facilities like mobile caravans or transportable lunchrooms. Employees working in remote areas, such as forestry or mining employees, may face severe limits in accessing dining facilities. At times, the only enclosed facility they can use may be their work vehicle. In this case, employers should consider providing them with portable food storage facilities like a car fridge, thermoelectric car cooler or insulated lunch box.

Part 2 – Facilities

Personal storage

90. Secure storage needs to be provided for employees to store their personal property, including when employees work in multiple places within worksites or across multiple worksites. There should be enough space to reach and use the storage facility.

91. Employers should provide accessible, secure storage at the workplace for the personal property of employees that:

    - allows personal items (like handbags, jewellery, personal identification documents, personal medication or hygiene supplies) to be stored securely while the employee is at work, and
    - is separate from the storage facilities provided for personal protective clothing and equipment to avoid contamination of personal property.

92. Where work involves employees bringing and using their own tools, employers need to provide secure and weatherproof storage places for those tools during non-working hours. Where the workplace is temporary or mobile, employers need to provide lockable containers that can be held in a safe place.

93. Where lockers are provided, they may also serve as secure storage for other personal items.

Changing rooms

94. Where employees need to change in and out of clothing or other apparel at work, employers need to ensure that the employees have access to private, secure, convenient changing areas with secure storage for personal belongings.

Design

95. Employers need to ensure that all employees who need to change clothes at the workplace have access to private changing facilities. This includes employees who need to:

    - wear personal protective equipment (PPE) while they are working
    - wear particular clothing, such as uniforms, while they are working
    - leave their work clothing at the workplace.

Note

As well as being a physical health hazard, not being able to access suitable changing room facilities in workplaces where employees need to change clothes at work may also be a psychological or psychosocial hazard, or discrimination, or other unlawful workplace situation. Employers need to consider other relevant laws (both state and federal) that may also apply to providing adequate workplace facilities.

See also AS 1428.1 *Design for access and mobility* and other requirements about disability and ambulant access needs.

Part 2 – Facilities

96. Employers must consult with employees when deciding whether the facilities are adequate for the welfare of all employees, so far as is reasonably practicable. OHS Act s35(1)(c)

97. Generally, separate male and female changing rooms need to be provided in workplaces where employees need to change clothing. However, employers should consider the needs and make-up of the workforce when deciding on the number of male, female, all genders or accessible changing rooms needed.

98. As well as the male and female changing rooms, at least one all genders ambulant changing room needs to be included in workplaces where employees are required to change their clothes at work, so far as is reasonably practicable.

99. The changing room needs to allow a clear space of at least 0.5m^2 for each employee, not including space used for other facilities like seats and lockers. Accessible changing rooms need to meet the National Construction Code dimensions for accessible adult changing facilities.

100. The temperature in the changing room needs to be at a comfortable level for employees getting changed. Extra heating or cooling may be needed.

Fittings

101. Changing rooms need to have:

- enough seating for all employees who are changing at the same time to sit down when dressing or undressing
- accessible mirrors, either inside the room or just outside of it
- enough hooks.

102. Employers should consult with employees and any HSRs about other fittings that may be needed in changing rooms.

Storage

103. Where change rooms are provided, employers need to provide each employee with a locker for storing clothing and personal items. Storage lockers should:

- be well ventilated, accessible and secure
- be at least 300mm wide, 450 mm deep and 1800mm high
- have hooks and a coat hanger rail.

104. There also needs to be a clear space of at least 1800mm between rows of lockers that are facing each other and at least 900mm between lockers and a seat or a wall. Where the workplace is temporary or is located away from buildings or other fixed accommodation, employers need to provide portable private facilities that have secure storage and seating.

Part 2 – Facilities

Shower facilities

105. Employers need to provide changing and washing facilities for employees who work with hazardous contaminants.

106. Where asbestos removal work is being done, employers, self-employed persons and asbestos removal licence holders must provide decontamination facilities for the whole of the asbestos removal work.

107. Employers should provide showers for work activities that require strenuous effort or leave employees dirty and smelly or exposed to atmospheric contaminants.

Note

As well as being a physical health hazard, not being able to access suitable shower facilities at workplaces where employees need to shower at work may also be a psychological or psychosocial hazard, or discrimination, or other unlawful workplace situation. Employers need to consider other relevant laws (both state and federal) that may also apply to providing adequate workplace facilities.

See also AS 1428.1 *Design for access and mobility* and other requirements about disability and ambulant access needs.

108. Employers need to provide at least one shower cubicle for every 10 employees who may need to shower.

109. Separate facilities need to be provided for employees of different genders, unless the shower facilities are fully enclosed and can be secured and include adequate space to change inside the cubicle to protect privacy, to allow for use by all genders.

110. Employers need to consider the needs and make-up of the workforce. They must consult with employees when deciding whether the facilities are adequate for the welfare of all employees, so far as is reasonably practicable. OHS Act s35(1)(c) For example, employers may need to provide at least one universal fully accessible shower, to ensure that employees with accessibility needs can safely use the shower facilities. Similarly, employers may need to designate at least one private all genders shower.

111. The maximum hot water temperature should be set to a safe temperature to avoid scalding.

112. Showers need to be kept in a hygienic condition and cleaned regularly as needed depending on the number of employees and how often the facilities are used.

For information

Employers may also choose to support their employees by providing showers for commuters and for workplace wellbeing, to encourage and promote physical fitness and healthy lifestyles.

Part 2 – Facilities

Design

113. Showers should have:

- a floor area of at least 1.8m^2
- a slip-resistant surface that can be sanitized
- screens between each shower which are at least 1650mm high and at most 300mm above the floor
- an adjacent dressing area for each shower that has a seat and hooks
- a lockable door enclosing the shower and dressing cubicle.

114. Employers need to consider whether portable shower units of the same standard for employees working in remote or temporary locations are reasonably practicable.

115. All passageways to showers need to be in addition to the required shower space.

Facilities for showers

116. Each shower needs to have clean hot and cold running water and individual soap or other personal cleaning product.

117. If grime or other by-products of the work process cannot be removed just by washing, individual nail or scrubbing brushes should be provided.

118. Drying facilities, such as clean towels, need to be provided when the type of work means that employees need to shower before they can leave the workplace.

For information

In some workplaces, the work process involves substances that can be a contamination hazard, such as chemicals, lead, asbestos or infectious agents. In some workplaces, employers are required to provide facilities to enable employees to decontaminate themselves by showering and other means before leaving work. These additional duties are in the OHS Regulations.

Part 3 – Facilities for special workplaces

119. Some employees work in workplaces with special facility requirements and employers must consider their work environments as well as their health, safety and access to facilities in their workplaces, so far as is reasonably practicable.

Outdoor work

120. Employers need to provide outdoor employees access to suitable shelter for eating meals and taking breaks, and for protection from unsafe weather conditions, so far as is reasonably practicable.

121. Outdoor employees need to be protected from the adverse effects of sun and UV exposure, so far as is reasonably practicable. WorkSafe's website has information on ways to protect employees who work outdoors.

122. Employers need to ensure employees can access shelter such as shelter sheds, caravans, tents, windbreaks or portable shade canopies. Sometimes employer-provided work vehicles or public facilities may give suitable short-term shelter.

For information

UV radiation

Exposure to UV radiation is a risk factor for skin cancer. The WorkSafe website and the Cancer Council have more information on protecting employees who work outdoors from skin cancer risks.

Air quality

When the air quality is poor as a result of bushfires it can affect the health of employees working outdoors. Employers must monitor conditions, which includes outdoor air quality, and where unsafe, implement actions to, so far as is reasonably practicable, eliminate the risk to employees. Where it is not reasonably practicable to eliminate the risk, then employers must minimise the risk to employees. For example, it may be appropriate to discontinue or re-schedule outdoor work. For information about how to control the risk of exposure to bushfire smoke go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

The Environment Protection Authority Victoria (EPA) monitors air quality across Victoria. For more information on AirWatch visit **epa.vic.gov.au**

Part 3 – Facilities for special workplaces

Mobile, temporary, and remote work

123. Many employees work away from the employer's primary workplace, either in other workplaces or moving between workplaces. Examples of remote and mobile workers include:

- sales representatives
- labour hire or agency employees
- bus, taxi, removalist, and truck drivers
- delivery drivers
- visiting community welfare and health care employees
- park rangers and forestry employees
- security personnel
- carpark attendants
- utility company employees
- trades employees, eg plumbers and electricians
- emergency services employees,
- office staff working from a home office.

124. Employers must also ensure that mobile, temporary and remote employees have adequate facilities at any workplace that they manage or control, so far as is reasonably practicable.

125. Employers need to ensure that mobile, temporary and remote employees have reasonable access to basic facilities. For example, employees need to have reasonable access to toilets, drinking water, dining facilities, or to hygienic storage for food and water. Although they may not control the mobile workplace, employers must consult with their employees about adequate mobile workplace facilities. Employers should, for example, arrange with clients to allow their employees to use their facilities, such as toilets. If this is not reasonably practicable, then employers need to give their employees clear direction about the location of public facilities that they can use. Employers may need to provide water to mobile employees for their health and welfare.

126. Employers need to consider their workforce and where employees have additional needs such as accessibility, they need to identify accessible toilet facilities for their employees to use.

127. Employers should provide temporary facilities, like dining caravans or sheds, bottled water, portable toilets and mobile change rooms and storage facilities when employees work remotely at a single location. Where temporary facilities are provided, they should be located close to where the employees are working for easy access.

128. Mobile and remote employees also need to be provided with access to appropriate first aid. For more information see the First aid in the workplace compliance code.

Part 3 – Facilities for special workplaces

Communications for mobile, isolated and remote employees

129. Employers need to provide a means of communication that are reliable in an emergency for mobile, isolated and remote employees. Communications systems should be able to quickly locate employees or enable quick communication to seek help. Some examples of communication or location systems are satellite or mobile phones, radios, duress alarms and global positioning systems (GPSs).

130. Employers need to ensure that the technology selected is supported by the infrastructure in the work location (for example mobiles phones may not have adequate coverage in some rural areas).

131. Where practicable, employers should ensure that employees do not work alone or in isolated environments. There should always be at least two employees working together. Where employees need to work in isolated environments or alone, employers need to maintain regular communication with the employee.

132. When implementing systems of work, employers should consider what isolated, mobile and remote employees need in cases of emergency, for example a satellite or mobile telephone or duress alarm.

133. For information about working alone go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

For information

The WorkSafe website has information for employers on providing facilities for mobile and remote employees in certain industries, such as for linehaul or long haul truck drivers and for visiting health services.

Employer-provided accommodation

134. Employees sometimes use employer-provided accommodation. Examples are where employers provide accommodation for remote or seasonal work like mining, hospitality, major events, shearing or fruit picking. In addition, employers may provide accommodation at permanent workplaces such as hospitals or in disability care.

135. The accommodation needs to be separated from any physical workplace hazards and employers need to consider risks to the employees' physical and psychological health and safety when using the accommodation.

136. Employers should maintain regular contact with employees in remote accommodation, especially those working alone. For employees in remote or isolated accommodation, employers need to consider:

- social isolation, including lack of access to cultural activities or food
- lack of support
- fatigue.

Part 3 – Facilities for special workplaces

137. When providing accommodation, employers need to consider other relevant matters including the following:

- the accommodation is lockable, with safe access
- fire safety arrangements
- electrical safety standards are met
- drinking water is provided
- there are suitable toilets, as well as washing, bathing and laundry facilities
- procedures to ensure cleanliness
- exposure to violence or aggression
- suitable sleeping accommodation, including noise reduction so far as is reasonably practicable
- there are crockery, utensils and dining facilities
- rubbish is collected
- heating, cooling and ventilation meet the relevant Australian Standards (see Appendix C) for ventilation and air conditioning
- there is suitable lighting, including block-out blinds for sleeping areas where shiftwork requires daytime sleeping
- there are storage cupboards and other suitable furniture
- there is a refrigerator or cool room
- the accommodation meets structural and stability requirements
- the fittings, appliances and any other equipment supplied are kept in good repair
- there is access to reliable internet and communication service

For information

Labour hire providers must comply with the minimum accommodation standards under law in Victoria. Please see the website of the Victoria Labour Hire Authority at **www.labourhireauthority.vic.gov.au** for more detailed information.

Part 4 – The work environment

Entry and exit

138. Persons who manage or control a workplace must ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, that employees can enter and leave the workplace safely and without risks to health, including people with additional needs or disabilities. OHS Act s26

139. To ensure workplaces are safe, entries and exits need to be slip-resistant when wet and dry, and be well lit.

140. Employers need to ensure that there are separate entries and exits for mobile plant and equipment (eg forklifts or trucks) from that for pedestrians, so far as is reasonably practicable, to lower the risk of people being hit by moving vehicles.

141. Doors and gates should be fitted with safety devices if needed, eg a traffic sensor system, in a warehouse environment. Doors on main traffic routes should have a transparent viewing panel, unless they are fire-rated doors.

142. Employers, if they have management or control of a workplace car park, should ensure that the car park is well lit (artificially or naturally) and allows employees to enter, exit and move about easily without risk to health and safety. See the section on 'Lighting' in Part 4 of this code for further information on lighting.

Selecting the right lighting

Employers can also find more information on lighting in the relevant Australian Standards, see Appendix C, and in WorkSafe's guidance on *Safety in workplace car parks* available at **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

143. If the employer does not have management or control of workplace lighting (which can include a workplace car park) the employer needs to attempt to influence the person who does manage or control that workplace to fix any issues for the welfare of their employees.

Emergency exits and access

144. In workplaces that are buildings, the location of doors need to be clearly marked and signs posted to show the way to the exit doors for emergency evacuation. Employers need to ensure that emergency exits in buildings comply with the National Construction Code.

145. Employers need to ensure that access and egress, such as paths to exits, comply with the National Construction Code and are safe. 'Paths to exits' includes the space between plant, equipment, structure and materials.

146. Aisles and passageways in buildings need to be kept clear of obstructions at all times. In factories, warehouses, depots and similar buildings, aisles and passageways should be clearly marked so that the exit routes can be easily seen in an emergency. For example, side borders can be marked by a permanent line of white, yellow or clearly contrasting colour at least 50mm wide or by glowing markers.

Part 4 – The work environment

Housekeeping

147. Employers should arrange general cleaning of the workplace (for example hire cleaners), taking into account the need for hygienic upkeep of facilities in high-use areas like dining areas, toilets, urinals, hand basins and showers.

148. Housekeeping arrangements should account for cleaning linked with shift work, different types of work (for example greasy, grimy or dusty tasks) and employee numbers.

149. Waste containers should be placed in the areas where they are needed, like kitchens and toilets, and emptied regularly. Consumable items, like soap and toilet paper and paper towels, should be replaced or refilled regularly.

Note

Some cleaning agents may be classified as hazardous substances under the OHS Regulations. If your work involves hazardous substances, there are specific duties and obligations employers must comply with. For more information. See the Compliance code: Hazardous substances at **worksafe.vic.gov.au**

Workspace

150. The space given for employees in a workplace needs to be the right amount for the work being done.

151. Employees need to have enough clear space to have the full range of movement required to do the job and move around without strain or injury, taking into account the nature of the work to be performed.

152. Noting that not all workspace issues will involve physical hazards, employers need to consider whether psychological hazards exist. For example, to avoid exposing other employees to vicarious trauma risks, employers may need to provide quiet spaces or rooms for discussing or viewing sensitive or distressing material.

153. Workstations need to give employees clear space. The clear space does not include desks, benches, machinery and any other fittings. The minimum space required needs to be assessed and take into account:

- work processes and ergonomics
  - the task and the systems of work, including the physical actions needed to do the task like moving around while working
  - whether the task is done seated or standing
  - access to and from the work station
- the work equipment:
  - the equipment to be handled, for example use of knives can increase the risk of injury in close working conditions
  - any PPE that may be needed
- environmental factors:
  - heat or noise may also require increases above the recommended size
- psychological factors:
  - dealing with sensitive phone calls or clients may require enclosed or quiet spaces for those discussions or to avoid exposure to traumatic materials in open office plan area
- where relevant to their workplace, employers should ensure that they comply with the work area requirements in WorkSafe's online guidance, eg for offices.

Part 4 – The work environment

154. Employees need to be able to move freely around the workstation and not be obstructed by things like plant, furniture, materials or other employees. Employers need to ensure that there is at least 800mm of clear space for employees to move and work between plant, equipment, structures and materials. This lets employees work and move safely between machines, benches or counters. It will also let them evacuate quickly in an emergency.

155. Aisles, passageways and access to cupboards, storage or doors need to be calculated above the clear workstation space.

For information

Where relevant, employers should ensure that workplaces that are buildings comply with the space allocation in the National Construction Code.

More information on safe and compliant workspace can be found in WorkSafe's *Hazardous manual handling compliance code* at **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

Minimising noise in the work area

156. The OHS Regulations set a noise exposure standard for workplaces. If employees are exposed to noise that is above this standard, then the workplace is too noisy.

157. If you do not know if the workplace noise exceeds the noise exposure standard, then you must do a noise assessment in accordance with Part 3.2 of the OHS Regulations.

158. For more information see the Noise compliance code and the OHS Regulations Part 3.2 Noise.

159. Where noise is below the noise exposure standard and the OHS Regulations Part 3.2 are not engaged, employers should still minimise environmental noise as much as possible to reduce stress and distractions for employees. For example, the amount of noise in the workplace can be reduced through flooring and locating break or meeting areas away from work stations.

160. Other controls could include enabling employees to move to a quiet area, providing sound-proof booths for phone work or meetings, providing noise cancelling headphones, or through protocols.

Heat and cold

161. Workplaces that are too hot or too cold can cause employees to be less productive or less alert, or make them feel tired. These factors can contribute to employees' being injured, ill and having other medical conditions. They can be a risk to employees' health and safety if not controlled, so far is as reasonably practicable.

162. It is important to understand the difference between an employee feeling discomfort and a work environment that creates a health risk. For example, air temperature may feel very uncomfortable but not be a risk to health.

163. The term 'thermal comfort' means a person's level of comfort at different temperatures. A person may feel too hot or too cold in a workplace but the conditions may not be extreme enough for the person to suffer an illness or injury. People often have different experiences of comfort at different temperatures. Employers need to consider the makeup of their workforce when setting indoor workplace temperatures and consult with employees about comfortable working temperatures.

Part 4 – The work environment

164. Health risks to employees increase as workplace conditions move further away from temperatures that are usually found to be comfortable. Conditions resulting from hot and cold temperatures include:

- heat-related illness, which can happen when working in high temperatures, exposure to high thermal radiation or high levels of humidity. Employees at risk of heat-related illness can include those in commercial kitchens or laundries, or those working outdoors like removalists, agricultural workers, and emergency services personnel, and
- cold-related illness including hypothermia, which can happen when a person's body temperature drops too low from exposure to cold environments like those in commercial freezers or meat processing facilities, or in outdoor winter environments.

165. The environmental conditions and physical wellbeing of employees needs to be monitored when work involves extended or repeated exposure to heat or cold. Employers must, so far as reasonably practicable, monitor the health of employees and the conditions of the workplace. OHS Act s22(1)(a) and OHS Act s22(1)(b) This is particularly important when work involves extended or repeated exposure to heat or cold.

166. Employers must provide information, instruction, training and supervision to employees so that they can work safely. OHS Act s21 For work that involves exposure to extreme temperatures, this may include information, instruction, training and supervision on:

- risk control measures and their intended effect in hot or cold work environments, and
- how to:
  - use temperature-related PPE properly
  - recognise the early symptoms of heat stress or hypothermia, and
  - follow safe work procedures like reporting problems without delay.

167. Employers must have control measures for employees working in extreme heat or cold, to ensure that they reduce health and safety risks, so far as is reasonably practicable. Some relevant control measures are listed in the table at Appendix F.

Hot environments

168. If it is not possible to eliminate extreme heat exposure, employers need to reduce the risk of heat-related illness, so far as is reasonably practicable.

Part 4 – The work environment

169. Heat-related illness can occur when the body cannot cool itself enough. The key risk factors that need to be taken into account are:

- air temperature
- humidity (in the environment or workplaces like laundries and mines)
- radiant heat (from the sun, through car windows, or from other sources like furnaces and ovens)
- air movement or wind speed
- workload (nature of the work and duration)
- physical fitness of the worker (including acclimatisation and known pre-existing conditions)
- clothing (eg PPE and standard uniforms that could make it worse)
- isolation and working alone.

170. Employers must monitor work conditions and the health and safety of employees when they have identified that the heat hazard is significant.
OHS Act s22(1)(a) and OHS Act s22(1)(b)

Determining the risk of heat stress in the workplace using wet bulb globe temperature

Use of a Heat Stress Index, such as the wet bulb globe temperature (WBGT), is a useful way to assess whether there is a heat stress or illness risk for employees.

A WBGT reading takes into account factors such as wind/air speed, radiant heat and cloud cover (when used outdoors), temperature and humidity. A WBGT differs to a standard thermometer which only takes into account temperature.

Further guidance can be found in WorkSafe Victoria's Guidance Note Working in heat.

Cold environments

171. If it is not possible to eliminate exposure to extreme cold, employers must lower the risk of cold-related illness, so far as is reasonably practicable. Some relevant control measures are listed in the table at Appendix F.

172. Immediate help should be given to employees who show signs of hypothermia. Signs of hypothermia can include:

- numbness in hands or fingers
- uncontrolled shivering
- loss of fine motor skills, particularly in hands (employees may have trouble with buttons, laces, zips)
- slurred speech and difficulty thinking clearly
- irrational behaviour (sometimes a person will remove clothing).

Thermal comfort

173. A number of things can affect a person's feeling of thermal comfort, including humidity, air temperature, air movement, clothing and physical activity.

174. Working outside the ideal comfort environment can cause thermal discomfort, and can contribute to low morale and productivity. It can affect an employees' ability to make decisions or perform manual tasks safely. Employers should consult with their employees to determine the optimal workplace temperature for employees' thermal comfort.

175. For inactive, sedentary or desk-bound work, the workplace should be kept at between 20°C and 24°C, depending on the time of the year and clothing worn.

176. Employees doing physical work usually prefer a lower temperature range because they generate heat in their body through the physical activity. Generally, indoor workplace temperatures for active work should not be kept below 18°C.

177. All heating and cooling facilities need to be serviced regularly and maintained in proper working order. Employers may also have obligations to maintain and test facilities under relevant Victorian Public Health and Wellbeing legislation or other requirements. Heating and cooling systems in motorised vehicles being used in connection with work should also be kept in good order.

178. Having a comfortable temperature for the type of work will depend on the thermal environment and the level of activity. Employers should consider the following:

- air conditioning
- fans
- electric heating
- open windows
- building insulation
- the layout of workstations
- direct sunlight control
- controlling air flow and the source of draughts
- task
- clothing
- work and rest regime.

For information

In some workplaces, temperature is more than a comfort issue and it can become a hazard. There are ways to measure if there is a risk of temperature-related illness at work. Employers should seek advice from a qualified and competent person, like an occupational hygienist, to assess the workplace and recommend solutions.

To meet their duties to eliminate or reduce hazards and risks for extreme temperatures, employers should think about issues like WBGT (see above note on 'Determining the risk of heat stress in the workplace using wet bulb globe temperature') and use advice like WorkSafe's guidance.

Ventilation, air quality and air conditioning

179. Workplaces inside buildings may have natural ventilation, mechanical ventilation like fans or extraction units, or air conditioning.

180. Mechanical ventilation or air conditioning needs to comply with *AS 1668.2: The use of ventilation and air conditioning in buildings* and relevant ventilation and air conditioning laws or other requirements.

181. Natural ventilation needs to consist of permanent openings such as windows and doors that:

- in total are the size of at least five per cent of the floor area of the room
- are open to the sky, an open covered area, or a properly ventilated adjoining room.

182. In enclosed workplaces, employers need to ensure that the rate of air movement remains comfortable (usually between 0.1m and 0.2m per second).

Part 4 – The work environment

For information

In some workplaces, ventilation and air quality are more than issues of comfort and must be addressed by employers when working out how to eliminate or reduce risks from airborne particles. Some work processes can cause or create hazardous particles that contaminate the air, like those involving biological materials, lead, asbestos, crystalline silica or other chemicals.

Employers must consult the Regulations to make sure they are meeting their duties to eliminate or reduce hazards and risks from airborne contaminants.

Employers may have obligations under other legislation, for example obligations to inspect, monitor and maintain air conditioning and warm water systems under the relevant Victorian Public Health and Wellbeing legislation.

Hazards from bushfire smoke

When the air quality is poor as a result of bushfires it can affect the health of employees working indoors due to Heating Ventilation and Air Conditioning (HVAC) systems drawing in outside air.

Employers must monitor outdoor air quality and where unsafe, implement actions to, so far as is reasonably practicable, eliminate the risk to employees. Where it is not reasonably practicable to eliminate the risk, employers must minimise the risk so far as is reasonably practicable.

For information about how to control the risk of exposure to bushfire smoke go to **worksafe.vic.gov.au**.

Lighting

183. Lighting from natural or artificial sources needs to be provided for employees to ensure that working conditions suit the nature of the work, the location of the work and the times when the work is done. See 'Recommended maintained illuminances for various types of tasks, activities or interiors', below.

184. If the workplace is a building, employers need to comply with the relevant lighting provisions contained in the National Construction Code.

185. The lighting in a workplace needs to allow employees and others to move about easily and safely. It needs to allow them to do their work effectively, without using awkward postures or straining their eyes to see.

186. For some tasks, general workplace lighting will not be enough and local lighting may be needed in a certain area or different lighting at different times of the day. For example, employees loading a transport vehicle outdoors have different lighting needs when they work at night than they do during the day.

187. Factors that employers need to consider when providing lighting include:

- the nature of the work activity
- the nature of hazards and risks in the workplace
- the work environment
- illumination level, including natural and artificial light and the impact on fatigue, alertness and circadian rhythms
- transition of natural light over the day
- glare
- contrast
- reflections.

188. The lighting needs to make the visual environment better and needs to be free from glare including reflective glare, flicker and stroboscopic effect.

Recommended maintained illuminances for various types of tasks, activities or interiors (from AS/NZS 1680.1 *Interior and workplace lighting*)

Class of task	Recommended illuminance lx	Characteristics of the activity/interior	Representative activities/ interiors
Movement and orientation	40	For little-used interiors with visual tasks limited to moving around.	Corridors; cable tunnels; indoor storage tanks; walkways.
Rough intermittent	80	For interiors used intermittently, with visual tasks limited to movement, orientation and coarse detail.	Staff change and locker rooms; live storage of bulky materials; dead storage of materials needing care; loading bays.
Simple	160	Continuously occupied interior with visual tasks (coarse detail only). Occasional reading of clearly printed documents for short periods.	Waiting rooms; entrance halls; staff canteens; rough checking of stock; rough bench and machine work; general fabrication of structural steel; casting concrete; automated process monitoring; turbine halls.
Ordinary or moderately easy	240	Continuously occupied interiors with moderately easy visual tasks with high contrasts or large detail.	School boards and charts; medium woodworking; food preparation; counters for transactions; computer use.
Moderately difficult	320	Areas where visual tasks are moderately difficult with moderate detail or with low contrasts.	Routine office tasks (eg reading, writing, typing, enquiry desks).
	400		Inspection of medium work; fine woodwork; enquiry points; car assembly.
Difficult	600	Areas where visual tasks are difficult with small detail or with low contrast.	Drawing boards; most inspection tasks; proofreading; fine machine work; fine painting and finishing; colour matching.
Very difficult	800	Areas where visual tasks are very difficult with very small detail or with very low contrast.	Fine inspection; paint retouching; fine manufacture; grading of dark materials; colour matching of dyes.

Part 4 – The work environment

Seating

189. Wherever a task can be done while seated, employers need to provide employees with suitable seating. Employers also need to provide suitable seating where the work cannot be done while seated, but employees can sit sometimes. This lets the employee change their position between sitting and standing and rest, if needed.

190. Employees should not remain in a seated, standing or otherwise static posture for prolonged periods. Employers should provide opportunities for employees performing seated or standing work to vary their postures and movements.

191. The type and design of seating needs to provide suitable body support and be right for the type of work being done. Employers should also consider the needs of the employees, noting that body support needs will differ from person to person.

192. Seating that is wrong for the task can pose a health and safety risk to employees. Prolonged sitting may have a variety of adverse health effects like affecting the trunk muscles and greater compression on spinal discs and lower back pain.

193. Employers need to consider the effects of vibration in seats/seating, for example seating provided for transport drivers (eg truck, bus, train, tram drivers) and mobile, rotating or vibrating plant operators.

For information

Employers must also comply with the manual handling obligations in Part 3.1 of the OHS Regulations. Employees must not be forced to use sustained, inappropriate or awkward body positions.

Employers can also find more information on chairs in the relevant Australian Standards (for example AS/NZS 4438 *Height adjustable swivel chairs*), see Appendix C and WorkSafe's *Officewise: A guide to a health and safety in the office handbook* available at **worksafe.vic.gov.au**

Flooring

194. The choice of flooring will depend on the type of work being done, the materials used for the work, the chance of spills and the need for washing. Employees who do stationary standing work need to be protected from the risk of injuries from standing for periods on concrete, masonry, or steel floors, so far as is reasonably practicable.

195. Where the type of work allows, employers should ensure that floor insulation is provided at places where employees need to stand on concrete, masonry, or steel floors. The insulation may consist of any suitable material, like carpet, cushion-backed vinyl, shock-absorbent underlay, anti-fatigue matting, grates or duckboards. Employers should also consider the effect of flooring on the noise levels in the workplace.

196. Floors should be inspected regularly and need to be kept in good order, to eliminate or reduce slip and trip hazards. Common examples of hazards include trailing cables, uneven edges or broken surfaces, grates or covers, loose mats, or carpet tiles.

197. Some floor surfaces or covers can be a hazard in some work situations. The choice of floor cover needs to take the work process into account. Some examples include:

- metal machining can produce hot scrap, so sealed or fire-safe floor surfaces are needed
- uninsulated flooring creates a risk from electricity
- resistant floor material is needed for work using chemicals
- some work can create slip or trip risks, like grease, water or other fluid spills, or material off-cuts.

198. Floor covers also need to be chosen for hygiene and lack of resistance to push/pull forces from employees using mobile plant or equipment. Floor covers can also create manual handling risks, for example pushing or maneuvering wheelchairs on floor that is too soft. Floor covers and surfaces must be checked regularly and kept in good order, to eliminate slip and trip hazards. Consider slip hazards when choosing cleaning methods as some cleaning agents may increase slip risks.

For information

Information on floor surface risk assessments and choosing suitable floors is also contained in AS 4663: *Slip resistance measurement of existing pedestrian surfaces*, AS 4586: *Slip resistance classification of new pedestrian surface materials* and HB 197: *An introductory guide to the slip resistance of pedestrian surface materials*.

Part 5 – Responding to emergencies

Emergency planning

199. Employers should plan for emergencies in all workplaces that they manage or control.

200. Employers must provide information, instruction and training to employees. OHS Act s21 This needs to include emergency response procedures, including to employees with designated roles, such as fire/emergency evacuation wardens where appropriate.

201. Employers need to ensure that paths to exits are safe and comply with access and egress requirements. Aisles and passageways in buildings need to be kept free of furniture or other obstructions at all times. In factories, warehouses, depots and similar buildings, aisles and passageways should be clearly marked so that the exit routes can be easily seen in an emergency. For example, side boundaries can be marked by a permanent line of white, yellow or clearly contrasting colour at least 50mm wide or by glowing markers.

202. Employers, or persons with management or control of workplaces, need to provide emergency response features such as firefighting equipment, smoke hazard management and emergency lighting, exits and warnings in buildings.

For information

There are additional requirements under the OHS regulations for emergency management plans for some industries. For further information and effective emergency response plans visit **worksafe.vic.gov.au**

Employers also need to comply with relevant Australian standards such as AS 3745 *Planning for emergencies in facilities* and AS4083 *Planning for emergencies – Health care facilities*, see Appendix C.

Emergency management plans

203. Employers need to ensure that all workplaces under their management and control have an emergency management plan ('plan') that all employees can access at all times, which clearly tells them what to do if there is an emergency. The plan needs to:

- give employees tools to respond safely to incidents or events that create an emergency which could pose a threat to life, health or property
- include the controlled exit of people from the workplace
- expand on action required under Victorian legislation, regulations and guidelines to prevent risks to life, health or property.

Part 5 – Responding to emergencies

204. There are different kinds of emergencies, for example fire, explosion, dangerous chemical release, medical emergency, natural disaster, bomb threats, aggression or violence, or robbery. Employers and employees using the plan must be able to respond safely to incidents or events that create an emergency which could pose a threat to life, health or property.

205. The plan needs to be based on the hazards in the work or workplace and the possible results of those hazards. Outside hazards can also affect the safety of the workplace (for example a chemical storage facility near the workplace) and should be considered when writing the plan. The plan needs to suit the size of, and hazards at, the worksite and the number and type of occupants.

206. The plan needs to identify and list key emergency personnel (eg fire wardens, first aid staff with photos, contact details).

207. Employers need to ensure that the plan is written down. The processes in the plan need to be simple, clear and flexible. All employees must be able to access the plan at any time, for example the plan should be put on display in the workplace (on a noticeboard).

For information

WorkSafe's *Communicating occupational health and safety across languages* compliance code has practical advice to employers for giving information to employees in languages other than English.

208. Employers need to ensure that employees, managers and supervisors are taught and trained in the emergency processes and hold regular practice runs for relevant emergency procedures.

Note

Employers, or persons who manage or control workplaces, need to comply with the relevant provisions of the National Construction Code for emergency response features in buildings. The National Construction Code provisions cover the requirements for fire-fighting equipment, smoke hazard management and emergency lighting, exits and warnings in buildings, see Appendix C.

First Aid

209. Practical guidance on suitable first aid facilities, including for mobile and remote employees, is in WorkSafe's *First aid in the workplace* compliance code.

210. First aid facilities may include things such as first aid kits, first aid equipment and sharps disposal units.

List of appendices

Appendix A

The compliance framework

Appendix B

The relationship between facilities and employee health, safety and welfare

Appendix C

Documents associated with this compliance code

Appendix D

Number of toilets and washbasins needed for employees in a workplace

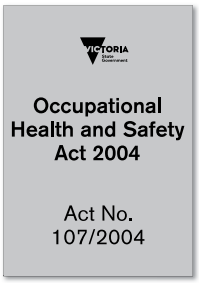
Appendix E

Facilities planning checklist

Appendix F

Heat and cold risk controls

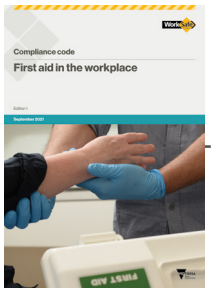
Appendix A – The compliance framework



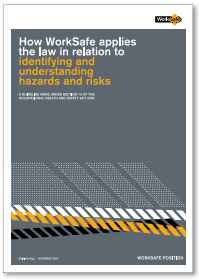
The Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004 (OHS Act) sets out the key principles, duties and rights in relation to occupational health and safety.



The Occupational Health and Safety Regulations 2017 (OHS Regulations) specify the way in which a duty imposed by the OHS Act must be performed, or prescribe procedural or administrative matters to support the OHS Act (eg requiring licences for specific activities, the keeping of records or giving notice).



Compliance codes provide practical guidance to duty holders. If a person complies with a provision of a compliance code, they are deemed to comply with the OHS legislative duty covered by the code provision. However, compliance codes are not mandatory, and a duty holder may choose to use some other way to achieve compliance.



WorkSafe positions are guidelines made under section 12 of the OHS Act that state how WorkSafe will apply the OHS Act or OHS Regulations or exercise discretion under a provision of the OHS Act or OHS Regulations. WorkSafe positions are intended to provide certainty to duty holders and other affected parties.



Non-statutory guidance includes information published by WorkSafe aimed at building people's knowledge and awareness of OHS issues, risks to health and safety, and the disciplines and techniques that can be applied to manage and control risks. Non-statutory guidance is not mandatory, nor does it provide any *deemed* to *comply* outcomes for duty holders. This guidance does, however, form part of the *state* of *knowledge* about OHS.

Appendix B – The relationship between facilities and employee health, safety and welfare

Workplace facility	Link to employee health*, safety and welfare
Drinking water	For basic health and welfare. Water is essential for bodily functioning.
Toilets	For basic health, welfare, privacy and dignity.
Sanitary disposal	For basic health, welfare, privacy, dignity and personal hygiene.
Washing facilities	For personal hygiene. Some industries may also have specific requirements for washing facilities, such as decontamination or to avoid cross-contamination.
Dining rooms	Provides a hygienic area and a place away from the work environment for rest breaks and the consumption of food. This reduces the likelihood of food being contaminated by substances used in work processes.
Shelter	For respite from weather (eg heat, cold, rain, wind).
Seating	Provides the opportunity to alternate between standing and sitting to reduce fatigue and discomfort.
Temperature	Workplace temperature ranges appropriate to the work help improve employee comfort and reduce workplace incidents and fatigue.
Workspace	Enhances welfare by taking into account the nature of the work being performed and allowing employees a full range of movement required to do the job and to move safely, without strain or knocking against obstructions. Workspace can positively or negatively impact psychological health and welfare.
Lighting	Allows employees to move about easily and carry out their work safely without straining to see.
Change rooms	Enables employees to change into and out of appropriate clothing (eg uniforms or dirty work clothing) with privacy, safety and security. Some industries may have specific requirements for changing facilities depending on the hazards.
Personal storage	For the secure and clean storage of personal belongings or clothing, lockable where necessary.

**The term 'health' includes psychological health.*

Appendix C – Documents associated with this compliance code

These documents do not form part of this compliance code, although they may have regulatory status in their own right. They are included only to indicate other sources of information that may be useful to employers.

Regulations

- Occupational Health and Safety Regulations 2017
- Public Health and Wellbeing Regulations 2009

WorkSafe publications (available at worksafe.vic.gov.au)

- Compliance Code: Hazardous manual handling
- Compliance code: Communicating OHS across languages
- Compliance code: First aid in the workplace
- Compliance code: Facilities in construction
- Compliance code: Noise
- Compliance code: Hazardous substances
- Officewise: A guide to health and safety in the office
- Safety in workplace car parks

Australian standards

- AS 1428.1 *Design for access and mobility, Part 1: General requirements for access – New building work*
- AS 1851 *Routine service of fire protection systems and equipment*
- AS 3745 *Planning for emergencies in facilities*
- AS 4083 *Planning for emergencies – Health care facilities*
- AS 4485.2 *Security for health care facilities, Part 2: Procedures guide*
- AS 4586: *Slip resistance classification of new pedestrian surface materials*
- AS 4663: *Slip resistance measurement of existing pedestrian surfaces*
- HB 197: *An introductory guide to the slip resistance of pedestrian surface materials*
- AS 1668.2 *The use of ventilation and air conditioning in buildings, Part 2: Mechanical ventilation in buildings*
- AS/NZS 1680 *Interior and workplace lighting*
- AS/NZS 4438 *Height adjustable swivel chairs*

Other relevant publications

- National Construction Code 2022, volume 1, class 2 to class 9 buildings
- Australian Drinking Water Guidelines, National Health and Medical Research Council

Appendix D – Number of toilets and washbasins needed for employees in a workplace

The following table sets out what WorkSafe considers to be the minimum number of toilets, urinals, and washbasins needed for employees in a workplace, so far as is reasonably practicable.

Type of Building		Number of toilet pans	Number of urinals**
Buildings other than schools	Male	1 per 20 males*	1–10 employees: no urinals required 11–25 employees:1 urinal 26–50 employees: 2 urinals >50 employees: add 1 per each additional 50 employees
	Female	1 per 15 females*	Not required
	All genders^	1 per 50 employees*	None
Schools	Male	1 per 20 males*	1–10 employees: no urinals required 11–20 employees:1 urinal 21–45 employees: 2 urinals >45 employees: add 1 per each additional 30 employees
	Female	1 for the first 5 females, 1 more for each extra 15 females*	Not required
	All genders^	1 per 50 employees*	None

Appendix D – Number of toilets and washbasins needed for employees in a workplace

Type of Building	Number of washbasins
Storage-type buildings such as farms, sheds and warehouses Workshops, laboratory, factories	1 per 20* males 1 per 20* females 1 per 5 all genders sanitary compartments or part thereof
All other buildings	1 per 30* males 1 per 30* females 1 per 5 all genders sanitary compartments or part thereof

* Or part thereof, noting that for 10 or fewer employees only one accessible toilet is required.

** A urinal may be—

(a) an individual stall or wall-hung urinal; or

(b) each 600 mm length of a continuous urinal trough; or

(c) a closet pan used in place of a urinal.

^ All genders toilets are *in addition* to the specified male and female toilet numbers as well as accessible toilets.

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Location and nature of the workplace (page 8)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Is the workplace near appropriate facilities?		
Is the means of accessing the workplace safe?		
Do all employees on all shifts have access to the facilities?		

Drinking water (page 14)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are the drinking water outlets accessible to indoor employees?		
Are the drinking water outlets separate from toilet and washing facilities?		
Is the water hygienically provided – no shared cups or glasses?		
Is the water compliant with drinking water standards?		
Is the water cool and potable?		
Do employees who must remain at their workstation have water within reach?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Toilets (page 10)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Have accessible toilets been provided?		
Are there suitable toilets for all genders of employees in the workplace?		
Has the information in Appendix D been considered?		
Are toilets connected to the sewer or an appropriate alternative?		
Are toilets clearly marked and do they have lockable doors, adequate lighting and ventilation?		
Are the employee toilets separate from toilets for visitors, clients and the public?		
Is there adequate toilet paper, hand washing facilities including soap, rubbish bins and sanitary disposal?		

Hand washing (page 13)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are the hand washing facilities separate from work-related troughs or sinks, protected from weather and accessible from work areas, dining facilities and toilets?		
Is there at least 1m^2 of clear space per water outlet?		
Is hot and cold water, soap or another cleaning product provided?		
Are hygienic hand drying options provided that do not involve employees sharing towels? Eg paper towels, hand dryers or individual single use hand towels.		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Dining facilities (page 14)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Does the nature of the work cause a risk to the health, safety or welfare of employees from preparing food or eating in the workplace?		
Is a dining room or dining area required (taking into account the guidance in this compliance code)?		
Is there adequate protection from the elements, the work area, contaminants and hazards?		
For workplaces needing a dining room, is there 1m^2 of clear floor space for each person likely to use the dining room at one time?		
If a shared dining facility is used, can it accommodate all employees likely to be eating at one time?		
Is the means of access to a shared dining facility safe?		
Is the facility equipped with a sink and draining board, hot and cold water, washing utensils and detergent, microwave oven, vermin and dust proof storage, refrigerator, rubbish bins, boiling water and clean drinking water?		
Do the tables allow a minimum of 600mm width by 300mm depth of space per person?		
Are there seats with back support for all employees likely to be eating at one time?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Responding to emergencies (page 36)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Is there a written emergency management plan with simple, clear and flexible procedures?		
Is the plan accessible to all employees and others?		
Are employees, managers and supervisors instructed and trained in the emergency procedures?		
Are there appropriate emergency response features and equipment, including clearly marked exit routes and doors?		

First aid (page 37)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Do the first aid arrangements meet the requirements of the *First aid in the workplace* compliance code or equivalent?		
Is there appropriate needle/sharps disposal, if required? For example, in medical facilities or where an employee has medical needs		

Personal storage (page 18)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Is there accessible, secure storage at the workplace for employees' personal property, including any tools provided by an employee?		
Is it separate from any storage facilities provided for personal protective clothing and equipment?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Change rooms (page 18)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are change rooms provided for employees who are required to change in and out of clothing or other apparel?		
Are there arrangements in place for the privacy of employees of all genders?		
Do change rooms allow a clear space of at least 0.5m2 for each employee? Or more space per the National Construction Code requirements for fully accessible change rooms, if required for employees with additional accessibility needs?		
Is the change room temperature comfortable for changing clothing?		
Is there enough seating, accessible mirrors and an adequate number of hooks for the number of employees changing at one time?		
Are there well-ventilated, accessible and secure lockers for each employee for storing clothing and personal belongings?		
Are the lockers at least 300mm wide, 450mm deep and 1,800mm high, with hooks and a coat hanger rail?		
Is there clear space of at least 1,800mm between rows of lockers facing each other and at least 900mm between lockers and a seat or a wall?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Shower facilities (page 20)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are showers provided for employees whose work requires decontaminating after certain activities?		
Is there one secure shower cubicle for every 10 employees who may need to shower? Do any employees have accessibility needs and, if so, is the shower facility accessible?		
Are there separate facilities for employees of all genders or other appropriate forms of security to ensure safety and privacy?		
Is there a slip-resistant floor area of not less than 1.8m^2 that can be sanitised?		
Are partitions between each shower at least 1,650mm high and no more than 300mm above the floor?		
Is there a lockable door enclosing the shower and dressing cubicle, or an adjacent dressing area for each shower, containing a seat and hooks, with a curtain?		
Is there clean hot and cold water and non-irritating soap or other cleaning product?		
If employees need to shower before they can leave the workplace, are clean towels provided?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Workspace (page 27)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Is there safe access to and egress from the workstation?		
Is there at least 800mm of clear space between plant, equipment, structures and materials for employees to move and work?		
Is there enough clear space, taking into account the physical actions needed to perform the task, and any plant and personal protective equipment that is needed?		
Is there enough space in aisles and passageways and around cupboards, storage or doors, in addition to the clear workstation space?		
If quiet spaces are required at the workplace, for example to avoid noise exposure or view or discuss sensitive material privately to avoid psychological hazard to other employees, is there a quiet place such as a room with a door for employees to use?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Hot and Cold (page 28)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Have the conditions of the work, the workplace setting and weather been considered in setting appropriate indoor temperatures? Is the temperature between 20°C and 24°C (or less if the work is physically active)?		
Have you considered the makeup of the workforce and consulted with employees to determine the optimum temperature for the majority of employees? Note that thermal comfort can differ for males and females.		
Are heating and cooling facilities serviced regularly and maintained in a safe condition?		
Is appropriate protective clothing provided for employees who work in extreme temperature conditions?		

Ventilation, air quality and air conditioning (page 31)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are rates of air movement in enclosed workplaces between 0.1m and 0.2m per second?		
Are appropriate ventilation and air conditioning systems provided in compliance with the relevant public health and wellbeing legislation or other requirements?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Lighting (page 32)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Does the lighting allow employees to move about easily and carry out their work effectively without adopting awkward postures or straining their eyes to see?		
Is the working environment free of any glare, contrast or reflection?		
Is the working environment free of any flicker or stroboscopic effect?		
Is local lighting provided where required?		

Seating (page 34)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Can the work be done from a seated position?		
Does the seating provide suitable body support and is it appropriate to the type of work being performed?		
Is there additional seating for employees who work standing and need to sit from time to time?		

Floors (page 35)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Is adequate floor protection provided for employees who need to stand still for long periods?		
Is the floor insulation appropriate to the task?		
Are factors such as the work materials used, the likelihood of spills and the need for washing considered when choosing floor coverings?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Mobile, temporary, and remote work (page 23)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are there appropriate procedures to ensure that mobile or remote employees have access to clean drinking water, toilets, dining facilities, hygienic storage of food and water, and emergency and first aid assistance?		
Can mobile or remote employees access emergency communications that are reliable in their location, such as a satellite or mobile phone?		

Outdoor work (page 22)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are there appropriate procedures to ensure outdoor employees have access to clean drinking water, toilets, dining facilities, hygienic storage of food and water and emergency and first aid assistance?		
Is there access to shelter for eating meals and taking breaks and for protection when weather conditions become unsafe?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Employer-provided accommodation (page 24)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Is the employer-provided accommodation separate from any hazards at the workplace likely to present a risk to the health or safety of an employee using the accommodation?		
Is it appropriately equipped, including: • safe access and egress • security of personal possessions • fire safety arrangements • electrical safety standards • drinking water • toilets, washing, bathing and laundry facilities • procedures to ensure cleanliness, including hygienically clean bedding • suitable quiet sleeping accommodation • crockery, utensils and dining facilities • rubbish collection • heating, cooling and ventilation?		
Does the accommodation meet all relevant structural and stability requirements?		
Are the fittings, appliances and any other equipment supplied maintained in good repair?		

Consultation (page 5)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Has there been employee consultation on any decisions about the adequacy of the facilities?		
Have HSRs been consulted?		
Have independent contractors and their employees been consulted?		

Appendix E – Facilities planning checklist

Housekeeping (page 27)	✓/✗	Action to be taken
Are consumable items such as soap and toilet paper replaced regularly?		
Is broken or damaged infrastructure such as plumbing, air conditioning or lighting repaired promptly?		
Is equipment and furniture such as fridges, lockers and seating maintained in good repair?		
Are workplace facilities cleaned regularly, at least every shift change or daily?		
Are facilities reviewed periodically eg when work practices or workplaces are modified, more employees are engaged, new work processes are introduced or an incident impacting on the health, safety or welfare of employees occurs?		

Appendix F – Heat and cold risk controls

If it is not possible to eliminate exposure to extreme heat or cold, employers need to reduce the risk of heat or cold-related illness, so far as is reasonably practicable.

Some possible control measures are listed below. These are not an exhaustive list, but applied in certain circumstances these interventions may reduce risks.

Controls	Examples
Engineering controls	• correct air temperature with heating or cooling • increase air movement with fans • provide shade to reduce radiant heat from the sun • install shields or barriers to reduce radiant heat from hot sources such as furnaces • locate hot processes away from people where possible
Work practice controls	• limit time employees spend in the hot environment and increase recovery time in a cool environment • limit time employees spend in cold environment and increase recovery time in a warm environment • reschedule work so that certain tasks are done when temperatures are less extreme • reduce physical demands by using mechanical aids/tools • train supervisors and employees to recognise early signs of hypothermia or heat-related illness and the first aid treatment for those signs • use a buddy system where employees watch fellow employees for early signs of hypothermia or heat-related illness • provide employees enough cool water near their work area • provide suitable clothing for the temperature, if needed • provide personal protective equipment (PPE) for employees working outdoors, like wide brim hats, long sleeved shirts, sunglasses, and sunscreen • provide PPE for protecting from radiant heat exposure, like reflective aprons and face shields • change locations if possible • add rest breaks • regularly monitor employees' health and condition (eg by a health practitioner)

WorkSafe Victoria

This document is intended for general guidance purposes only. The Code provides practical guidance for those who have duties or obligations in relation to the *Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004* and the Occupational Health and Safety Regulations 2017. Employers and employees should always check the legislation and make their own assessment about what action they need to take to ensure compliance with the law.

WorkSafe Victoria

WorkSafe Agents
Agent contact details are all available at
worksafe.vic.gov.au/agents

Advisory Service
Toll-free 1800 136 089
Email info@worksafe.vic.gov.au

Head Office
1 Malop Street, Geelong 3220
Phone (03) 9641 1555
Toll-free 1800 136 089
Website worksafe.vic.gov.au

Information in your language
For information about WorkSafe in your own language, call our Translating and Interpreting Service (TIS National) on **131 450**.

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